

Directions and locations

Teaching guide

Help someone locate a place or an item.

Understand the distinction

Use north, south, east, and west for compass directions. Northeast combines north and east. On a map, check the orientation rather than assuming the top is always north.

Use top, bottom, left, and right to describe positions on a page or object: in the top-left corner; at the bottom of the page. A place can be in the north of a country or north of another place; these describe different relationships.

Compare the patterns

WITHIN AN AREA

The town is in the north of the country.

It lies inside the northern part.

RELATIVE POSITION

The station is north of the park.

Compare the station with the park.

ON A PAGE

The address is in the top-right corner.

This describes a page position.

Read each example and notice how its form changes the meaning. Use these distinctions to choose your answers on the following pages.

Check your understanding

Circle one answer for each question. There is one correct choice among the options shown. Check the answer key after choosing.

1. Which direction combines north and east?

- A. southeast
- B. northeast
- C. northwest

2. Where is something described as at the bottom of the page?

- A. Near the lower edge of the page.
- B. Near the upper edge of the page.
- C. Outside the page on its right side.

3. Does north of the city mean inside the city?

- A. No. It tells us the exact distance from the city.
- B. Yes. It must be inside the northern part of the city.
- C. Not necessarily. It gives a position relative to the city.

Choose the best response

Choose the response that fits the situation. Check both its meaning and its grammar.

4. The station is east of the park and its label is in the map's top-right corner. Which description preserves both details?

- A. The station is west of the park. Its label is in the top-right corner of the map.
- B. The station is east of the park. Its label is in the top-right corner of the map.
- C. The station is east of the park. Its label is in the bottom-left corner of the map.

Review your choices

Use the answer explanations on the next page. If you chose a different answer, find the detail that makes it unsuitable and try the question again.

Practice online

The web lesson gives feedback for the option you select and lets you try again. No written response is required.

Answers and explanation

1. B. northeast

The two compass directions combine into one word.

A: Southeast combines south and east.

C: Northwest combines north and west, not north and east.

2. A. Near the lower edge of the page.

Bottom describes a position on the page.

B: The bottom is the lower edge; the top is the upper edge.

C: At the bottom identifies a lower position on the page.

3. C. Not necessarily. It gives a position relative to the city.

In the north of the city explicitly places it inside the city.

A: North of gives direction, not a measured distance.

B: North of gives a position relative to the city; inside it is not guaranteed.

4. B. The station is east of the park. Its label is in the top-right corner of the map.

The first phrase locates the station; the second locates its label on the map.

A: West reverses the stated direction.

C: This changes the label's position.

Continue learning

Web lesson and related topics: englishladder.com/grammar-concepts/concept-19.html

A practical teaching sequence

1. Notice (2 minutes)

Read the comparison examples with the learners. Point out the meaning and form that distinguish each pattern.

2. Choose (4 minutes)

Learners select one option for each of the three checks. Keep the answer key covered. Use the selected option's explanation rather than presenting a generic model as feedback.

3. Apply (5 minutes)

The station is east of the park and its label is in the map's top-right corner. Which description preserves both details?

Learners choose the response that fits this situation. All responses in this activity are multiple choice; do not replace the choices with a written-answer task.

4. Review (3 minutes)

Compare selected options with the key. Use the option-specific notes to explain why a distractor does not fit. Let learners change their selection and try again.

Scope of the answer key

Each question has one correct option among the choices shown. This does not mean that every other way to express the idea is wrong. Preserve the qualifications in the teaching notes.

Feedback criteria

Check both grammatical form and the stated situation. A correct option answers this question; four correct choices do not certify a learner's overall proficiency.